

Northstar Platform Reliability Handbook

Document owner: Platform Reliability. Version: 1.0.

The Orion API has a monthly availability objective of 99.90 percent. Its interactive endpoint has a p95 latency objective of 250 milliseconds, measured at the service edge. The service owner is the Platform Reliability team. Error budget reviews happen every Monday at 14:00 UTC.

Routine production changes use the Tuesday and Thursday change windows from 09:00 through 15:00 UTC. Emergency security fixes may occur outside the window when the incident commander records the reason in the incident timeline.

Progressive delivery

Every Orion release starts with a 5 percent canary for 15 minutes. If the guardrails stay healthy, traffic increases to 25 percent for another 15 minutes, then to 100 percent. The release controller records each promotion.

Automatic rollback begins when the error rate rises by more than 1 percentage point above baseline or when p95 latency remains above 400 milliseconds for five consecutive minutes. A feature flag is not a substitute for rollback; the on-call engineer must confirm that the previous build is healthy.

Database migrations must be backward compatible for one complete release. Destructive schema changes require a separate reviewed cleanup release.

Incident response

A Sev-1 page must be acknowledged within five minutes. The first qualified responder becomes incident commander until an explicit handoff. The commander assigns communications and operations leads, maintains the timeline, and makes the final decision to resolve the incident.

The customer status page is updated at least every 30 minutes during a Sev-1. A blameless postmortem is published within 48 hours of resolution. Corrective actions must have one owner and a due date no later than 30 days after the postmortem. Reliability review verifies closure rather than accepting a verbal status update.